

Connecting the publishing platforms

Everything a brand can publish to, what each one needs from you, and where it stands today.

All fourteen platforms publish through native adapters. The Ayrshare aggregator is still there as a switchable fallback — see [The aggregator switch](#) — but nothing depends on it.

Where things stand

State as of the current `apps/api/.env`. "Configured" means this deployment holds the app credentials; whether a *brand* has connected an account is a separate question, answered per brand in **Settings** → **Account Connection**.

Working

PLATFORM	NOTES
X	Connected and publishing. Access tokens last 2 hours and now refresh automatically.
YouTube Shorts	Connected and publishing. Google's tokens last 1 hour and now refresh automatically.

Configured, but no account connected yet

PLATFORM	WHAT IS LEFT
TikTok	Keys are set. The connect flow reaches TikTok's consent screen and fails there on <code>client_key</code> — that error means the redirect URI, see Redirect URI .

Come free — no setup, ever

These four have no developer app and no Connect button, because they are not separate accounts. They publish through a connection another platform already made.

PLATFORM	PUBLISHES THROUGH	WHY
Instagram Stories	Instagram	Same account, same token; a story is <code>media_type=STORIES</code> on the container.
Facebook	Instagram	An Instagram Business account exists because a Facebook Page owns it. Meta issues both from one login.
Facebook Groups	Instagram	A Group that same Page identity administers. Needs a group id per post.
YouTube (long-form)	YouTube Shorts	Same channel, same token. "Shorts" is a duration and an aspect ratio, not a destination.

Connect Instagram and three of these light up at once.

Needs a new scope — reconnect required

PLATFORM	SCOPE ADDED	WHO IS AFFECTED
Instagram	<code>pages_manage_posts</code>	Any brand that connected Instagram before Facebook publishing shipped holds a token without this scope. Publishing to Instagram still works; publishing to the Facebook Page fails with a Graph permissions error. The fix is reconnecting in Settings — the adapter's error message says so rather than leaving you to decode error code 200.

No other platform's scopes changed. X already requested `offline.access`, which is what makes its refresh work.

Not configured yet

PLATFORM	KEYS NEEDED	APPROVAL GATE
Instagram (+ Facebook, Stories, Groups)	<code>META_APP_ID</code> , <code>META_APP_SECRET</code>	Yes — App Review for content publishing
LinkedIn	<code>LINKEDIN_CLIENT_ID</code> , <code>LINKEDIN_CLIENT_SECRET</code>	Yes — Community Management API access
Threads	<code>THREADS_APP_ID</code> , <code>THREADS_APP_SECRET</code>	Yes — App Review
Pinterest	<code>PINTEREST_APP_ID</code> , <code>PINTEREST_APP_SECRET</code>	Trial access works immediately on your own account; Standard needs review
Reddit	<code>REDDIT_CLIENT_ID</code> , <code>REDDIT_CLIENT_SECRET</code>	No
Google Business	<code>GOOGLE_BUSINESS_CLIENT_ID</code> , <code>GOOGLE_BUSINESS_CLIENT_SECRET</code>	Yes, and it is absolute — every API call returns 403 until Google approves the project

Needs nothing from you

PLATFORM	HOW IT CONNECTS
Bluesky	No developer app exists. Each brand connects with their own handle and an app password , created in their Bluesky settings. The adapter is always registered.

The redirect URI: one value every console must match

There is **one** `SOCIAL_REDIRECT_URI` shared by every OAuth platform, so the same string has to be registered, character for character, in each console.

Current local value:

```
http://127.0.0.1:8080/oauth/social/callback
```

On staging it is set by the deploy to `https://<api-host>/oauth/social/callback`.

127.0.0.1 and localhost are different strings to every provider. A mismatch is rejected on the provider's own consent screen before any code comes back, and only one of them tells you that:

PROVIDER	WHAT IT SAYS	WHAT IT MEANS
Google	Error 400: redirect_uri_mismatch	the URI is not registered
TikTok	"correct the following: client_key"	the URI is not registered
X	"You weren't able to give access"	the URI is not registered

Treat TikTok's `client_key` complaint as a redirect-URI problem until proven otherwise. If a console refuses to save a plain-`http` loopback URI, that provider needs HTTPS — point `SOCIAL_REDIRECT_URI` at an HTTPS tunnel to port 8080 and register the tunnel's `/oauth/social/callback` everywhere instead.

One more shared value: `OAuthStateSecret`. Every connect flow is gated on it — without it `integration.connect` is not registered at all and no brand can connect anything. Generate one with `openssl rand -base64 32`. It is already set locally and on staging.

Per-platform setup

Meta — Instagram, Instagram Stories, Facebook, Facebook Groups

One app serves all four.

1. **developers.facebook.com** → My Apps → Create App → type **Business**.
2. Add the **Facebook Login** product. Under its settings, add `SOCIAL_REDIRECT_URI` to *Valid OAuth Redirect URIs*.
3. Add the **Instagram Graph API** product.
4. Request these permissions under App Review:
 - `instagram_content_publish` — posting to Instagram
 - `pages_show_list`, `pages_read_engagement` — finding the Page
 - `pages_manage_posts` — posting to the Facebook Page
5. Copy **App ID** and **App Secret** from Basic settings into `META_APP_ID` and `META_APP_SECRET`.
6. The Instagram account must be a **Business or Creator** account and must be linked to a Facebook Page. A personal Instagram account cannot publish through any API.

Facebook Groups additionally needs Meta's Groups API permission *and* the Group must have installed your app. Meta restricted this heavily in 2020, so expect it to refuse for most brands. The adapter says so rather than failing vaguely.

TikTok

1. **developers.tiktok.com** → Manage apps → your app.
2. Add the **Login Kit** product, and under it register `SOCIAL_REDIRECT_URI` as a Redirect URI.
3. Add the **Content Posting API** product.
4. Scopes: `video.publish` , `user.info.basic` .
5. Client Key → `TIKTOK_CLIENT_KEY` , Client Secret → `TIKTOK_CLIENT_SECRET` .

Already configured here. The current failure is at step 2 — see [Redirect URI](#).

LinkedIn

1. **linkedin.com/developers** → Create app, associated with a Company Page.
2. Under **Auth**, add `SOCIAL_REDIRECT_URI` to Authorized redirect URLs.
3. Under **Products**, request **Share on LinkedIn** and **Sign In with LinkedIn using OpenID Connect**. Scopes: `w_member_social` , `openid` , `profile` .
4. Client ID → `LINKEDIN_CLIENT_ID` , Client Secret → `LINKEDIN_CLIENT_SECRET` .

LinkedIn tokens last 60 days and **cannot be refreshed** unless you are in their partner programme, so brands reconnect every two months. That is LinkedIn's constraint, not a gap here.

X

1. **developer.x.com** → Projects & Apps → your app.
2. **User authentication settings** → set up:
 - App permissions: **Read and write**
 - Type of App: **Web App, Automated App or Bot** (this is the confidential client type; the refresh flow depends on it)
 - Callback URI: `SOCIAL_REDIRECT_URI`
3. Use the **OAuth 2.0** Client ID and Client Secret — *not* the API Key/Secret from the 1.1 section. They live further down the Keys and tokens page.
4. → `X_API_KEY` , `X_API_SECRET` .

Scopes requested include `offline.access` , which is what makes the 2-hour token refreshable. Without it X returns no refresh token.

YouTube — Shorts and long-form

1. **console.cloud.google.com** → APIs & Services → **Enable** the *YouTube Data API v3*.
2. Credentials → Create credentials → **OAuth client ID** → Web application.
3. Add `SOCIAL_REDIRECT_URI` under **Authorized redirect URIs**.
4. OAuth consent screen: add scopes `youtube.upload` and `youtube.readonly`. While the app is in Testing, add each connecting Google account as a Test user.
5. → `YOUTUBE_CLIENT_ID`, `YOUTUBE_CLIENT_SECRET`.

Threads

Its own app — not the Meta one above. Threads has a separate OAuth host (`threads.net`), a separate graph, and separate scopes. A Meta app token does not authenticate against it.

1. **developers.facebook.com** → Create App → use case **Threads API**.
2. Threads API → Settings → add `SOCIAL_REDIRECT_URI` as a *Redirect Callback URL*.
3. Request `threads_basic` and `threads_content_publish`. Both need App Review before anyone outside your own test users can connect.
4. App ID / App Secret → `THREADS_APP_ID`, `THREADS_APP_SECRET`.

Pinterest

1. **developers.pinterest.com** → My apps → Create app.
2. Add `SOCIAL_REDIRECT_URI` under the app's Redirect URIs.
3. Scopes: `pins:write` and `boards:read`. `boards:read` is not optional — a pin must name a board, and that is how the list is offered.
4. → `PINTEREST_APP_ID`, `PINTEREST_APP_SECRET`.

A new app has **Trial access**, which only works against your own Pinterest account. Standard access needs a review submission.

Every pin needs a board id set on the campaign's accounts. There is no default, and the adapter refuses rather than guessing.

Reddit

1. **reddit.com/prefs/apps** → *create another app* → type **web app**.
2. **redirect uri** must equal `SOCIAL_REDIRECT_URI` exactly.
3. **Tick the reCAPTCHA**. The form will not submit without it, and Reddit does not say so — the button simply does nothing.
4. The **client id is the unlabelled string directly under the app name**; the secret is the field marked *secret*. Mixing these up is the usual first failure.
5. → `REDDIT_CLIENT_ID`, `REDDIT_CLIENT_SECRET`.

If **"create app" refuses**, the line about the *Responsible Builder Policy* is Reddit's standing footer, not an error — it is on the page before you touch anything. Two things actually block the button:

1. the unticked reCAPTCHA, which is the usual one; and
2. the *"you must also **register to use the API**"* link in the same sentence. Since 2023 Reddit requires a separate API registration, and an account that has not completed it cannot create an app. Follow that link, complete it, then come back to this form.

Neither is something this product can do for you, and neither is a code problem — the adapter and OAuth flow are built and waiting for the two keys.

These two keys are also read by the trend sources. One app, two uses, one pair.

Every post needs a subreddit set on the campaign's accounts. Reddit is the platform where posting to the wrong community costs the most, so there is no default and the adapter refuses without one.

Google Business Profile

A second Google OAuth client, separate from YouTube's. The scope is different and access is granted per project, so keeping them apart means a Business review cannot put YouTube publishing at risk.

1. **console.cloud.google.com** → Credentials → Create OAuth client ID → Web application.
2. Add `SOCIAL_REDIRECT_URI` under Authorized redirect URIs.
3. Enable **My Business Account Management API** and **My Business Business Information API**.
4. **Request API access** at `support.google.com/business/contact/api_access`. Until Google approves the project, every call returns 403. This approval is the long pole, not the code.
5. → `GOOGLE_BUSINESS_CLIENT_ID`, `GOOGLE_BUSINESS_CLIENT_SECRET`.

Every post needs a location. A profile with several branches has no default one.

Bluesky

Nothing to configure. Each brand connects their own account:

1. In Bluesky: **Settings** → **Privacy and Security** → **App Passwords** → **Add App Password**. Copy the `xxxx-xxxx-xxxx` value.
2. In SparkSocial, connect Bluesky with the handle (`name.bsky.social`) and that app password.

Use an **app password**, never the account password. App passwords are scoped and revocable on their own. The credential is verified against Bluesky before it is stored, so a typo fails at the form rather than at the first scheduled post.

Bluesky posts are text-only for now — attaching images needs a blob upload, which is not built. The post goes out without the image rather than silently dropping it.

The aggregator switch

Ayrshare covers all fourteen platforms with one API key and no per-brand OAuth. Two flags:

```
AYRSHARE_API_KEY=...           # the vendor key
PUBLISH_USE_AGGREGATOR=true     # in the routing table, BEHIND the natives
PUBLISH_PREFER_AGGREGATOR=true  # AHEAD of the natives – the real switch
```

Routing picks the first adapter that supports a platform. Now that all fourteen are native, `PUBLISH_USE_AGGREGATOR` alone changes nothing — nothing ever reaches it.

`PUBLISH_PREFER_AGGREGATOR=true` **is the lever**: it moves every platform onto Ayrshare without touching a connection, a token or a deploy, and removing it moves them all back. Worth pulling when a native app is rate-limited, awaiting re-approval, or misbehaving.

The API logs which order is live at boot.

After connecting: what to expect

Tokens refresh themselves. TikTok, X, YouTube, Pinterest, Reddit and Google Business all renew automatically — on a 15-minute clock, and again immediately before any publish that would otherwise use an expiring token.

Three platforms cannot refresh, by the provider's design, so brands reconnect by hand:

PLATFORM	TOKEN LIFE	WHY NO REFRESH
Instagram / Facebook	~60 days	Meta issues no refresh token
Threads	~60 days	Same; renewal is a different call against a different lifetime
LinkedIn	~60 days	Refresh tokens are gated behind LinkedIn's partner programme

Bluesky never expires — the app password is valid until revoked in Bluesky.

Settings → **Account Connection** shows each platform's adapter (`native:x` vs `aggregator:stub`) and connection health, and warns before a token dies.

Trend sources

Separate from publishing, and separate keys. Publishing is *where posts go out*; trend sources are *where ideas come in* — what `trend.rank` and the Discovery screen read to suggest what to post about.

Two are keyless and already live. With no keys at all the product still discovers trends; the rest widen the pool.

Where they stand

SOURCE	STATE	KEY
Google Trends	live	none — keyless
Hacker News	live	none — keyless

SOURCE	STATE	KEY
YouTube	live	<code>YOUTUBE_API_KEY</code>
Product Hunt	live	<code>PRODUCTHUNT_CLIENT_ID</code> / <code>_SECRET</code>
Reddit	not configured	<code>REDDIT_CLIENT_ID</code> / <code>_SECRET</code>
X	not configured	<code>X_BEARER_TOKEN</code>
TikTok	not configured	<code>TIKTOK_CREATIVE_TOKEN</code>
Pinterest	not configured	<code>PINTEREST_ACCESS_TOKEN</code>

An unset source is not an error. It is skipped, and the ones that are set carry the ranking — which is why four being live already means Discovery works today.

Setting up the four that are not

Reddit — the same app as Reddit publishing. One registration serves both, so if you complete [Reddit](#) above, this comes with it. Nothing extra.

X — a *bearer token*, not the OAuth client used for publishing. In **developer.x.com** → your Project → Keys and tokens → **Bearer Token**. It belongs to the app, not to a user, and needs no consent screen. Note X's free tier does not include the search endpoints this reads, so this source realistically needs a paid tier — which is why it is the one most reasonable to leave off.

TikTok — a Creative Center token, which is **not** the Login Kit client you use for publishing. It comes from TikTok's Marketing API, a separate application with its own approval. Genuinely optional.

⚠️ Your `.env` currently has a key named `TIKTOK_CREATIVE_CENTER_TOKEN`. The code reads `TIKTOK_CREATIVE_TOKEN`. If that value is a real token, renaming the key turns this source on; as it stands the value is being ignored and the source is silently off.

Pinterest — an access token from the same Pinterest app as publishing (**developers.pinterest.com** → your app → generate a token). Distinct from the per-brand OAuth connection: this one reads public trends and belongs to the deployment, not to a brand.

Turning a source off on purpose

Two sources have an explicit switch, because both can cost money and both are worth disabling independently of whether a key is present:

```
TREND_SOURCE_X_ENABLED=false
TREND_SOURCE_TIKTOK_ENABLED=false
```

Choosing which account gets connected

Only Google asks. Connecting YouTube or Google Business shows an account chooser every time — SparkSocial sends `prompt=select_account`, so it asks even when one account is signed in.

Every other platform connects whichever account the browser is already signed in to, and never asks. X, TikTok, LinkedIn, Meta, Threads, Pinterest and Reddit publish no documented way to request an account chooser on an OAuth 2.0 authorize URL. The browser session decides.

That matters most for agencies: connecting a client's account from your own laptop, while signed in to your own, silently connects yours.

Two things guard against it:

1. **Check what it says.** The confirmation names the account — "*X connected as @clienthandle.*" — not just the platform. If that is the wrong handle, Disconnect and reconnect.
2. **Connect from the right session.** Before connecting, either sign out of that platform in this browser, or use a private/incognito window and sign in as the account you want.

Bluesky has no ambiguity: you type the handle yourself.

Troubleshooting

SYMPTOM	CAUSE
<code>redirect_uri_mismatch</code> (Google)	The URI is not registered, or <code>localhost</code> vs <code>127.0.0.1</code>
" <i>correct the following: client_key</i> " (TikTok)	Same — the redirect URI, despite what it says
" <i>You weren't able to give access</i> " (X)	Same, or the app is not set to a confidential client type
" <i>X isn't configured for native publishing yet</i> "	That platform's keys are empty in <code>.env</code>
" <i>X publishes through your Y connection</i> "	A derived platform — connect Y instead
" <i>A brand must be selected</i> "	No brand is open. Open one from Brands first
Connect button does nothing / errors instantly	<code>OAUTH_STATE_SECRET</code> is unset, so the tool is not registered
Everything says <code>via aggregator:stub</code>	No native keys configured; publishing is going to the stub and nothing is being posted

An empty key is never an error. `envSet` treats present-but-empty as unset, so an unconfigured platform leaves its tool cleanly unregistered and the button simply is not offered — rather than registering it and failing at call time, which reads to a user as "the product is broken" instead of "this is not set up".